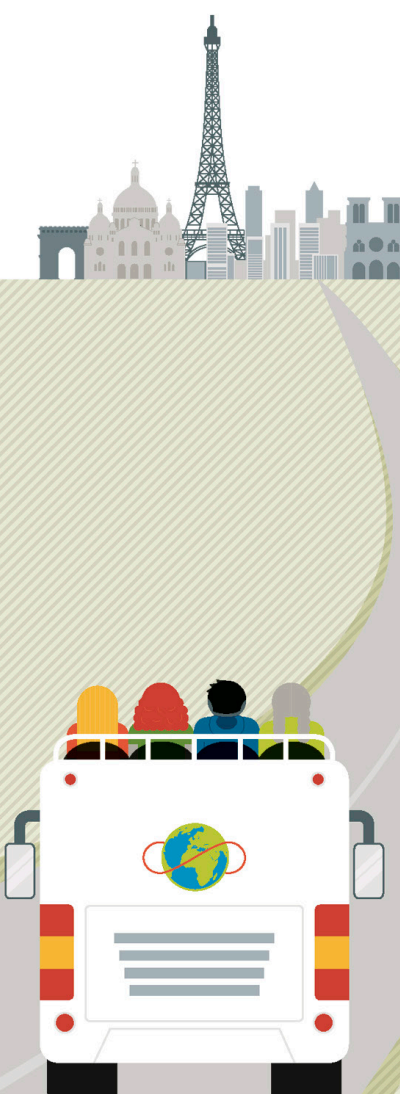




Creating a mission statement

A mission statement is a written declaration that clarifies the purpose of your business—what it does, who it does it for, and how it does it. It should be concise and give clear answers to three key questions:

What? Define the products or services that your business provides.

Who for? Say who your products or services are designed for.

How? Explain how your customers' aspirations will be met.

To support your mission statement, you can also write a vision statement, outlining where the business aspires to be in the future, having achieved its mission. You can also write a values statement, explaining the values your business will maintain in pursuit of its mission. Together, the three statements form a pledge between your business and those who deal with it.



CASE STUDY

Microsoft

In 1975, Bill Gates founded the software company Microsoft. Its initial vision was simple but ambitious: "to put a computer on every desk and in every home." The company aligned its strategy, communications, and culture to make that vision a reality. Since then, computers have become commonplace, and so the company has a new vision: "to empower every person and every organization on the planet to achieve more."

MOTIVATING OTHERS

Your mission statement (see above) not only provides focus for you, but it also serves as inspiration for others. It can be used to help attract and motivate staff, giving them a clear set of values to follow and a keen sense of what the business does and why. It can also be an important marketing tool, projecting a precise image of your business's unique identity—its brand—to the outside world, helping attract customers and clients. However, it is essential to demonstrate the values you portray, as failure to do so can undermine the message.